

A majority is local arithmetic

Chess Math

THE IDEA

A pawn majority means more pawns on one region of the board. Three pawns against two may be able to create a passed pawn through exchanges. Blockades, doubled pawns, and king activity determine whether that numerical potential can be realized.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A queenside three-versus-two majority is a useful long-term asset in an endgame. Pushing all three pawns without support can instead leave isolated targets and squares for the opposing king.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

Why does a three-versus-two majority not guarantee a passed pawn?

ANSWER AND REASONING

The pawns may be blocked, poorly arranged, or vulnerable to capture. Their advance must produce a favorable exchange sequence, and enemy pieces may stop the resulting passer.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Count the majority, then design the exchanges that make it work.